

Brunswick County Economic Profile

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Executive Summary

Performance Category: High Growth
County Size: Medium (20k-50k employees)
Region: Coastal

Brunswick County demonstrated strong economic performance from Q2 2024 to Q2 2025, with employment growth of 3.76%, wage growth of 5.14%, and establishment growth of 7.53%. All these important metrics exceed the statewide average.

Key Economic Indicators

Metric	Q2 2024	Q2 2025	Change	% Change
Employment				
Total Employment <i>vs NC State</i>	41,936	43,513	1,577	3.76% <i>+1.23 pp</i>
Wages				
Avg Weekly Wage <i>vs NC State</i>	\$953.00	\$1,002.00	\$49.00	5.14% <i>+1.82 pp</i>
Avg Annual Wage	\$49,559	\$52,121	\$2,562	5.17%
Establishments				
Total Establishments <i>vs NC State</i>	4,397	4,728	331	7.53% <i>+4.91 pp</i>
Employees per Establishment	9.54	9.20	-0.34	-3.56%
Total Wage Bill				
Total Quarterly Wages	\$519,585,841	\$566,990,144	\$47,404,304	9.12%

Table 1: Brunswick County economic performance metrics, Q2 2024 vs Q2 2025

How does North Carolina compare to the statewide average?

Comparison to North Carolina State Average

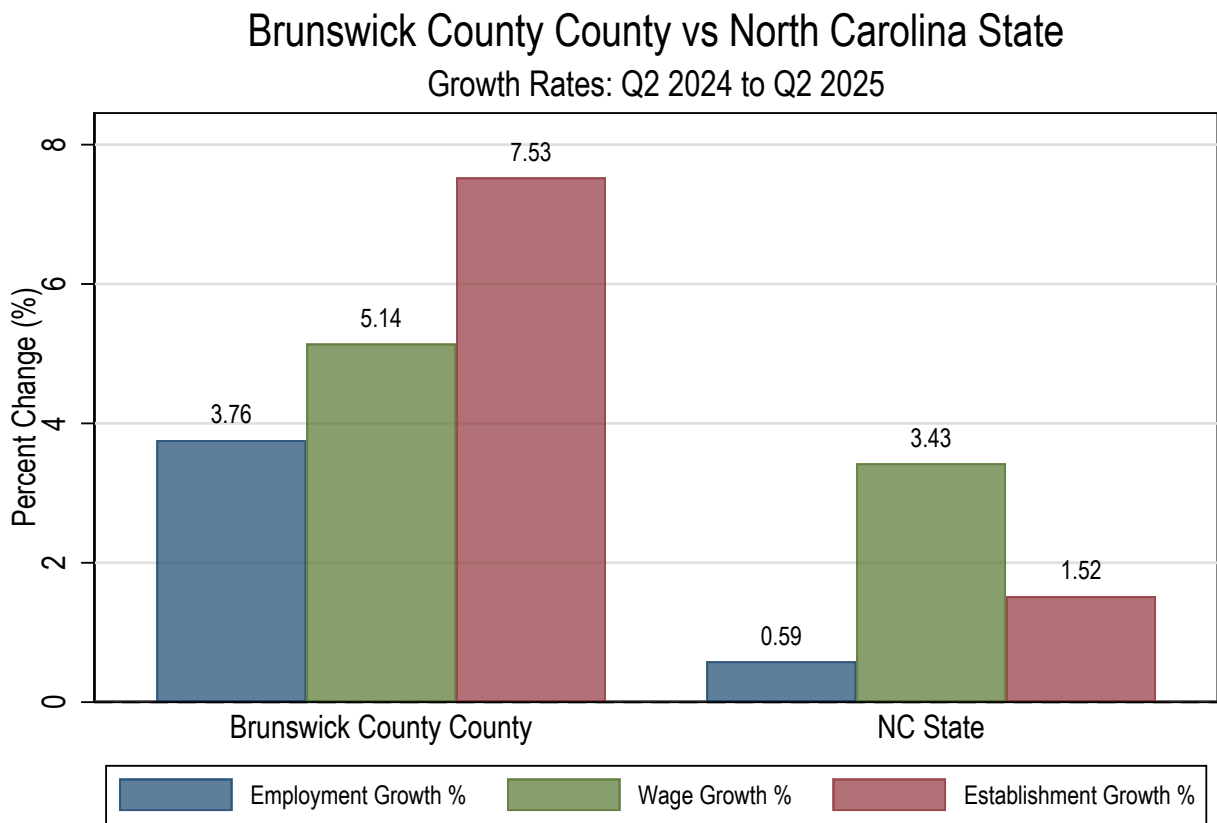
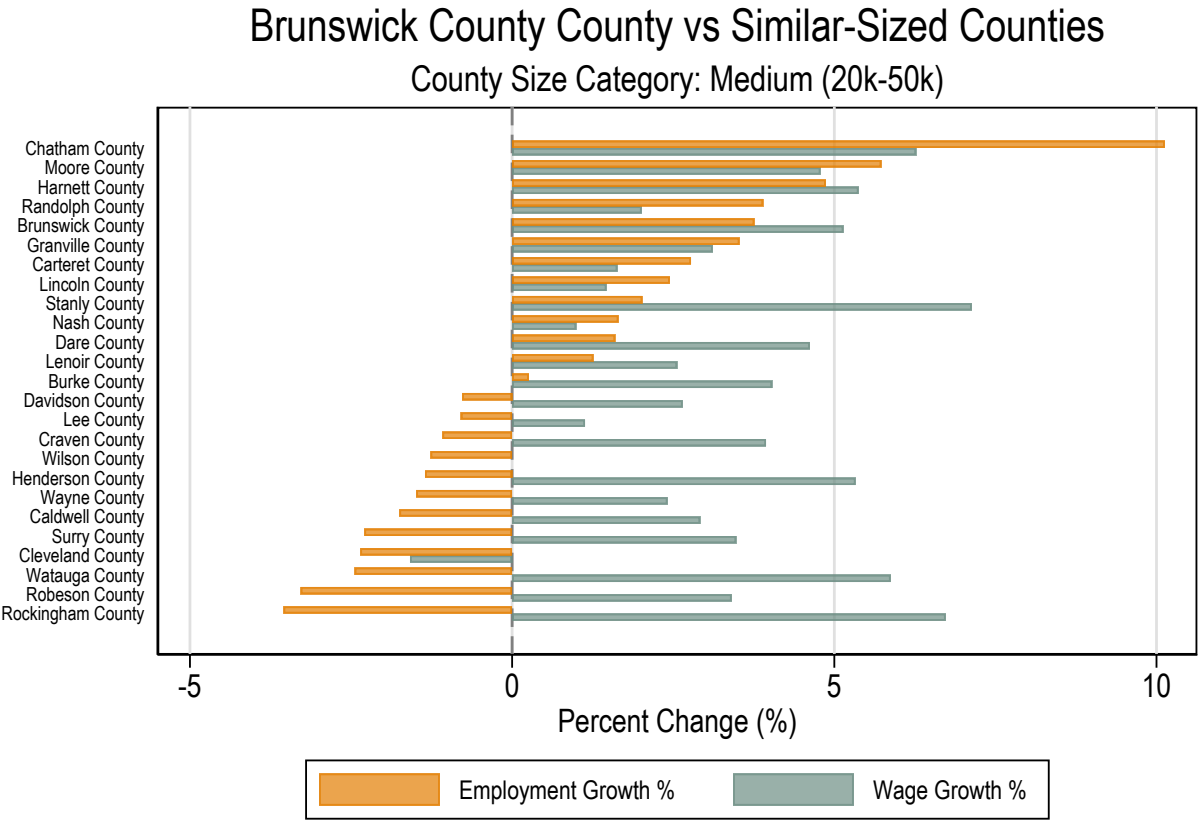


Figure 1: Brunswick County growth rates compared to statewide averages. All three key metrics exceed state performance.

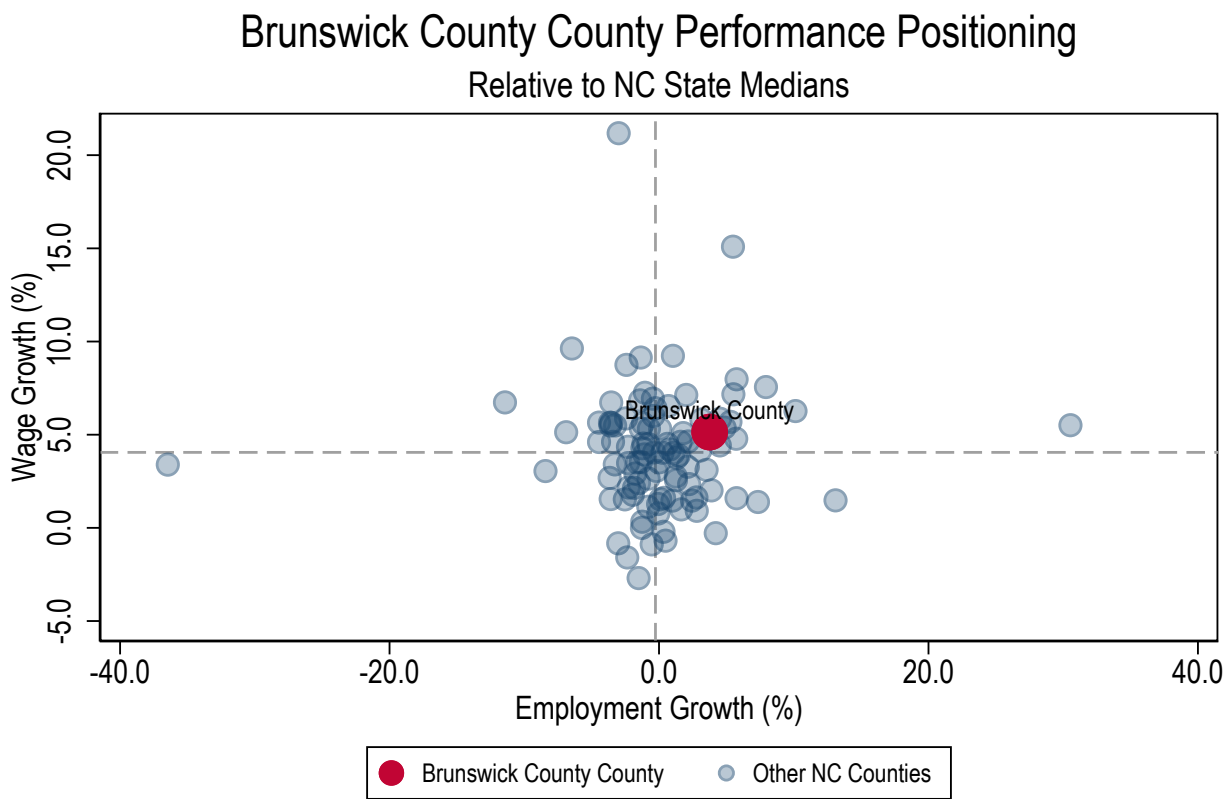
Similar-Sized County Comparison



Source: BLS QCEW

Figure 2: Comparison to other Medium-sized counties (20k-50k employees) across North Carolina.

How does Brunswick county compare?



Source: BLS QCEW. Bubble size reflects emphasis. Lines show state median growth rates.
Upper-right quadrant = above-median employment AND wage growth.

Figure 3: Brunswick County's position relative to all NC counties. Counties in the upper-right quadrant exceed state averages in both employment and wage growth.

Why do we care?

Key Findings

- **Strong Overall Growth:** Brunswick County's 3.76% employment growth significantly outpaced the state average, placing it in the "High Growth" category.
- **Wage Performance:** Average weekly wages increased by 5.14%, exceeding state wage growth by 1.82 percentage points, indicating quality job creation.
- **Business Formation:** With 7.53% establishment growth, Brunswick County saw robust business formation, adding 331 new establishments in just one year.
- **Tax Base Impact:** The total quarterly wage bill increased by 9.12% (\$47.4 million), suggesting strong growth in the local tax base.
- **Business Size Trend:** The slight decline in employees per establishment (9.54 to 9.20) suggests growth is being driven more by new small business formation than by expansion of existing large employers.

A little more context

Brunswick County's performance positions it favorably among both regional peers and similar-sized counties statewide. The county demonstrates balanced growth across employment, wages, and establishments, indicating a healthy and diversifying economy.

Bottom Line: Brunswick County is experiencing above-average economic growth across all major indicators, with particularly strong performance in business formation and wage growth.